

# AWS Amazon Inspector Lab: Host Vulnerability Assessment

## Summary:-

In this lab, Amazon Inspector was enabled to begin a Host Vulnerability Assessment of supported Amazon EC2 instances. After activation, Inspector automatically started scanning the operating system and installed software for potential security vulnerabilities. The service prepares findings that can later be reviewed to identify security risks and recommended remediation actions.

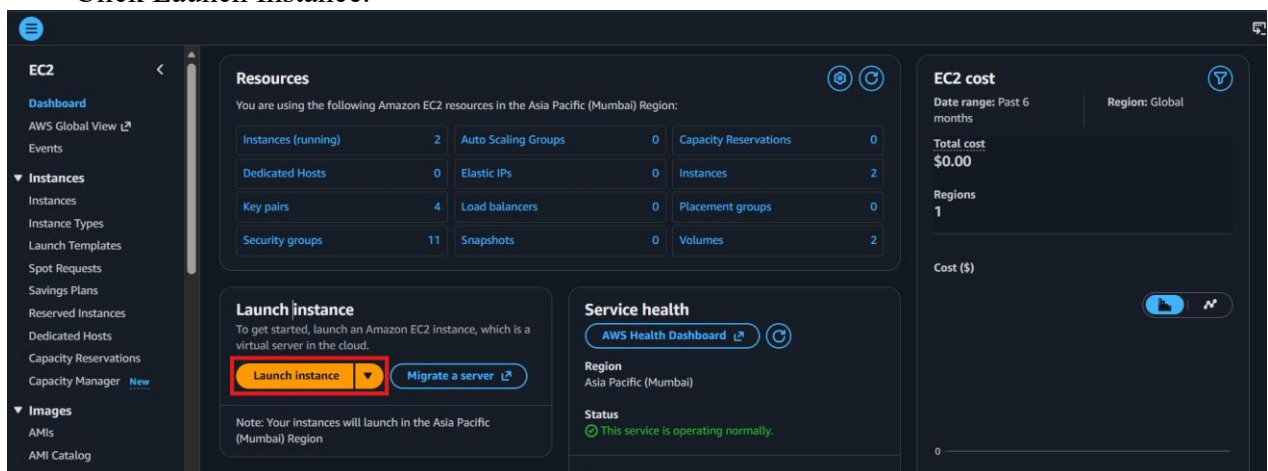
## Let's Start:-

- Amazon Inspector is an automated vulnerability management service that continuously scans supported Amazon EC2 instances.
- After activation, Inspector automatically begins assessing operating system packages and installed software for known security vulnerabilities.
- The scan results are categorized by severity levels such as **Critical, High, Medium, Low,** and **Informational**, helping prioritize remediation efforts.

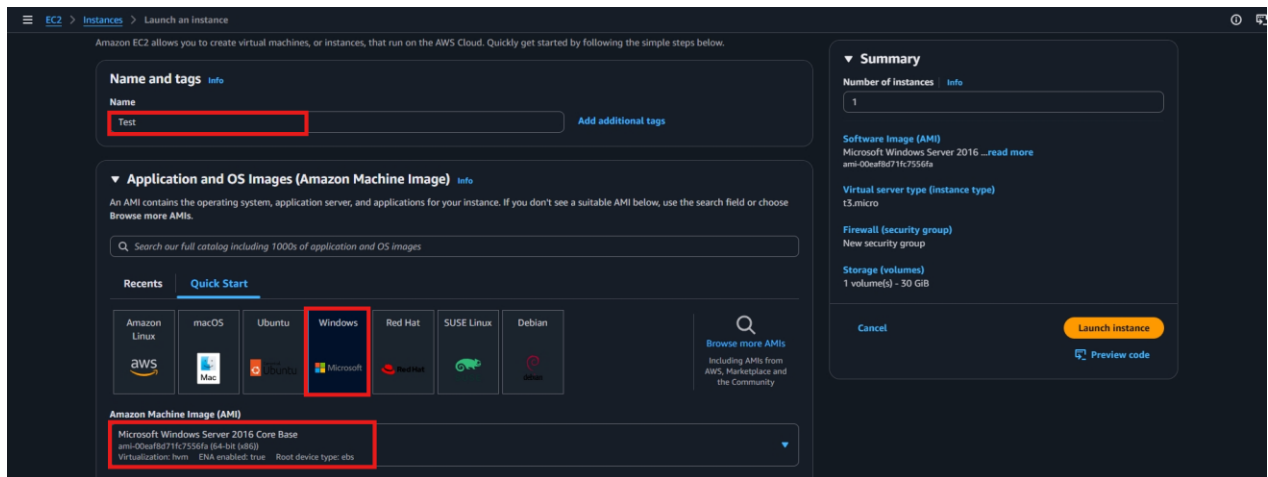
## Lab Steps:-

### Step 1 – Launch an EC2 Instance

- Navigate to the Amazon EC2 console.
- Click Launch Instance.



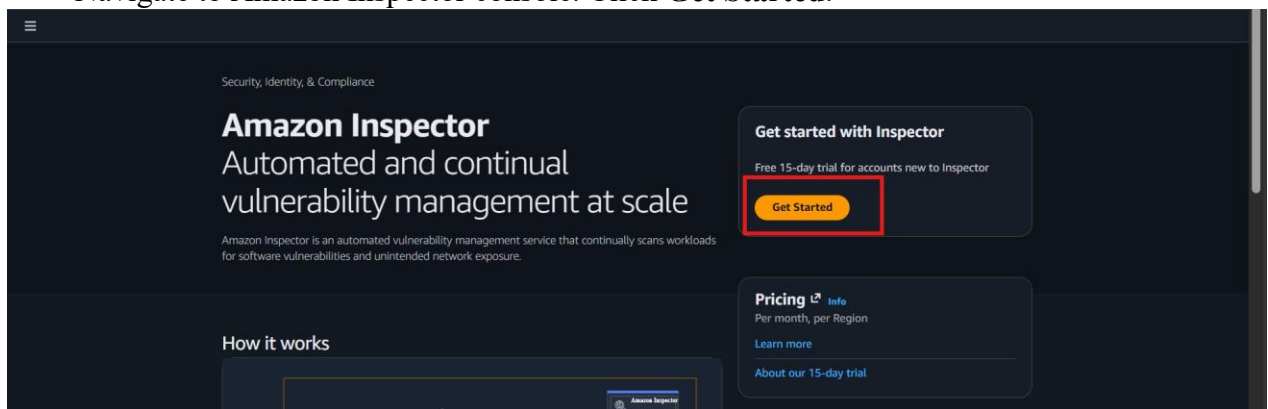
- Enter the instance name.
- Select Microsoft Windows Server 2016 Core Base as the Amazon Machine Image (AMI).



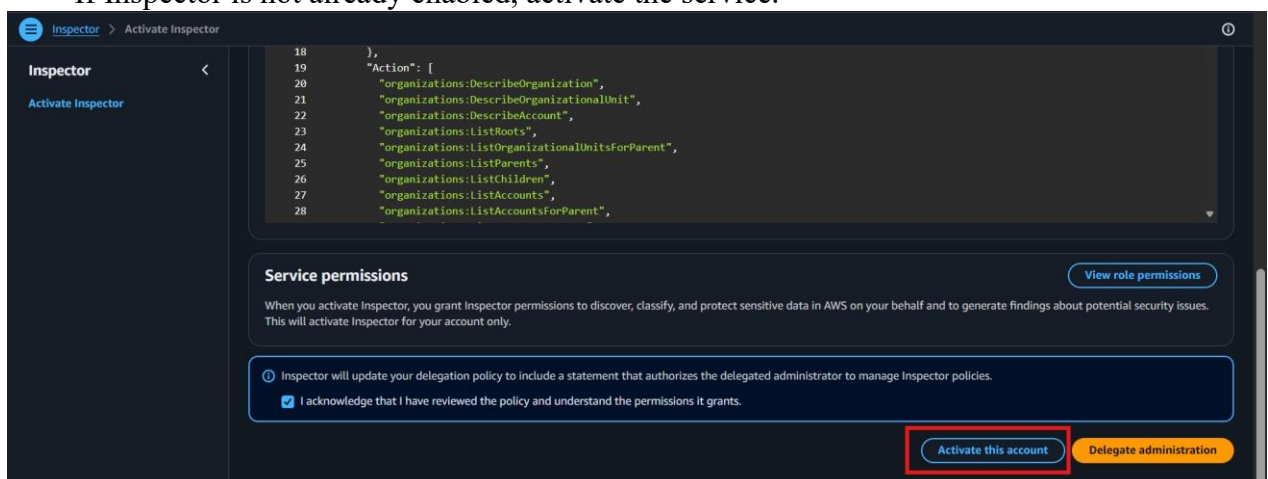
- Choose an eligible instance type.
- Select or create a key pair.
- Configure the required security group.
- Launch the instance and wait until its status changes to **Running**.

## Step 2 – Open Amazon Inspector

- Navigate to Amazon Inspector console. Click **Get Started**.



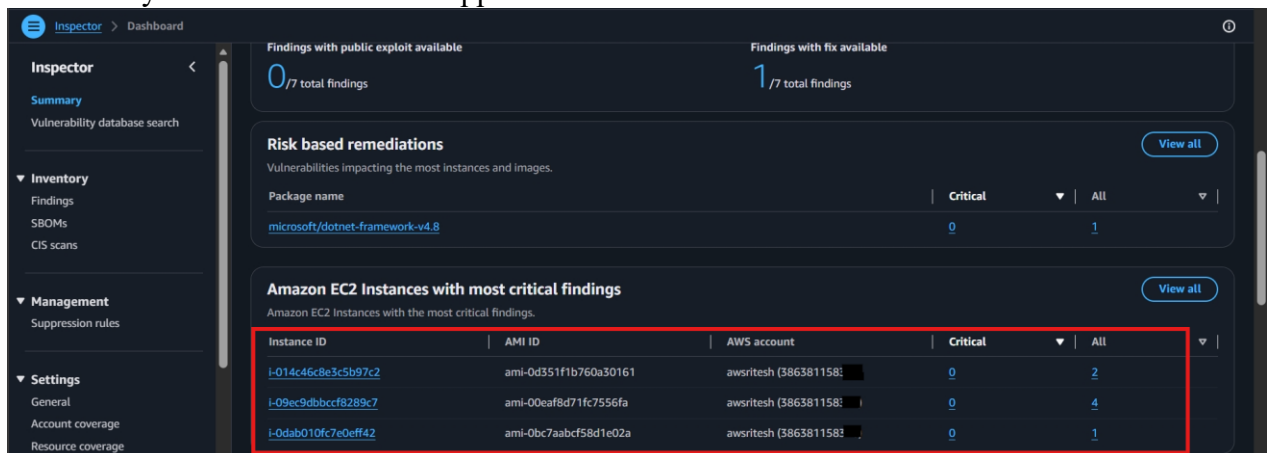
- If Inspector is not already enabled, activate the service.



- Wait until Amazon Inspector begins scanning supported resources.
- Verify that the dashboard displays the message:  
"Welcome to Inspector. Your first scan is underway."

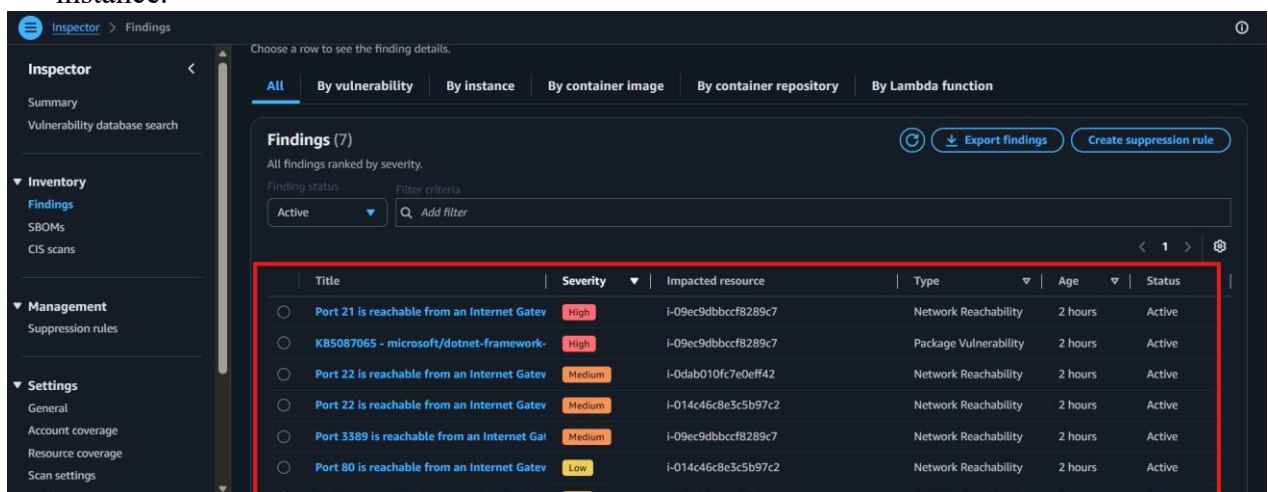
### Step 3 – Wait for the Initial Scan

- Wait approximately 5–15 minutes for Amazon Inspector to complete the initial scan automatically.
- Refresh the Amazon Inspector dashboard if required.
- Verify that the EC2 instance appears under the monitored resources.



### Step 4 – View Findings

- From the left navigation pane, click Findings.
- Wait until Amazon Inspector displays the vulnerability findings generated for the EC2 instance.



- Review the detected findings along with their severity levels and affected resources.

### Step 5 – Review a Vulnerability

- Open any vulnerability finding from the list.

**Port 21 is reachable from an Internet Gateway - TCP**  
 Finding ID: arn:aws:inspector:2ap-south-1:386381158340:finding/159754aa4aad8c737a59c5fa392a735

On the instance i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7, the port range 21-21 is reachable from the InternetGateway igw-04b16a448c271e78f from an attached ENI eni-00e0ec110adc98b00.

**Finding overview**

|                 |                                  |
|-----------------|----------------------------------|
| AWS account ID  | 386381158340                     |
| Type            | Network Reachability             |
| Open port range | [21, 21]                         |
| Severity        | High                             |
| Updated at      | July 4, 2026 3:14 PM (UTC+05:30) |
| Created at      | July 4, 2026 3:14 PM (UTC+05:30) |

**Resource affected**

|                   |                     |
|-------------------|---------------------|
| Resource ID       | i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7 |
| Type              | AWS EC2 Instance    |
| EC2 instance type | t3.micro            |

- Review the details, including the vulnerability description, affected EC2 instance, affected package, CVE ID (if available), and the recommended remediation.

## Step 6 – Filter Findings by Severity

- Return to the **Findings** page.
- Use the **Severity** filter to view findings based on their risk level.
- Review the findings categorized as **High**, **Medium** and **Low**.

**Findings (7)**

All findings ranked by severity.

Finding status: Active Filter criteria: Add filter

| Title                                       | Severity | Impacted resource   | Type                  | Age     | Status |
|---------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------|-----------------------|---------|--------|
| Port 21 is reachable from an Internet Gatev | High     | i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7 | Network Reachability  | 2 hours | Active |
| KB5087065 - microsoft/dotnet-framework-     | High     | i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7 | Package Vulnerability | 2 hours | Active |
| Port 22 is reachable from an Internet Gatev | Medium   | i-0dab010fc7e0eff42 | Network Reachability  | 2 hours | Active |
| Port 22 is reachable from an Internet Gatev | Medium   | i-014c46c8e3c5b97c2 | Network Reachability  | 2 hours | Active |
| Port 3389 is reachable from an Internet Gat | Medium   | i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7 | Network Reachability  | 2 hours | Active |
| Port 80 is reachable from an Internet Gatev | Low      | i-014c46c8e3c5b97c2 | Network Reachability  | 2 hours | Active |
| Port 80 is reachable from an Internet Gatev | Low      | i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7 | Network Reachability  | 2 hours | Active |

## Step 7 – Review the Dashboard Summary

- Navigate back to the Amazon Inspector Dashboard.
- Verify that the dashboard displays Environment Coverage, Critical Findings, Risk-based Remediations, and affected EC2 instances with vulnerability findings.

Inspector
Dashboard

**Environment coverage**
Your accounts, instances, repositories and lambda that are enabled with Inspector.

**Instances**
100%
3 / 3 instances

**Container repositories**
—
0 / 0 repositories

**Lambda functions**
—
0 / 0 Lambda functions

**Critical findings**
All active critical findings in your environment.

**ECR container**
0 Critical
0 total findings

**EC2 instance**
0 Critical
7 total findings

**Lambda functions**
0 Critical
0 total findings

**Findings with exploit available and fix available**
View the findings with exploit available and fix available coverage.

**Findings with public exploit available**
0 / 7 total findings

**Findings with fix available**
1 / 7 total findings

**Risk based remediations**
Vulnerabilities impacting the most instances and images.

Package name
Critical
All
microsoft/dotnet-framework-v4.8
0
1

Inspector
Dashboard

**Amazon EC2 Instances with most critical findings**
View all

Amazon EC2 Instances with the most critical findings.

| Instance ID                         | AMI ID                 | AWS account              | Critical | All |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------|----------|-----|
| <a href="#">i-014c46c8c3c5b97c2</a> | ami-0d351f1b760a30161  | awsritesh (386381158340) | 0        | 2   |
| <a href="#">i-09ec9dbbccf8289c7</a> | ami-00eaf8d71fc7556fa  | awsritesh (386381158340) | 0        | 4   |
| <a href="#">i-0dab010fc7e0eff42</a> | ami-0bc7aabc5f58d1e02a | awsritesh (386381158340) | 0        | 1   |

**Amazon ECR container images with most critical findings**
View all

Amazon Elastic container registry (ECR) container images with the most critical findings.

No ECR container images
No ECR container images to display.

**Amazon ECR repositories with most critical findings**
View all

Amazon Elastic container registry (ECR) repositories with the most critical findings.

| Repository name | AWS account | Critical | All |
|-----------------|-------------|----------|-----|
|-----------------|-------------|----------|-----|

## Verification

- Amazon Inspector successfully scanned the EC2 instance.
- Host vulnerabilities were detected and categorized by severity.
- Detailed vulnerability information and remediation recommendations were successfully reviewed.
- The Host Vulnerability Assessment was completed successfully.